

Q.2a (20 marks): How socioeconomic status influences exposure to environmental stressors affecting human growth

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Q2. (a) Discuss how socioeconomic status can influence exposure to environmental stressors that can influence the human growth and development

Growth: Acc. to Malina is the ^{before this point} quantitative change in size of body or its parts.

Development: It is qualitative changes that leads to mature & specialised individuals.

Differences

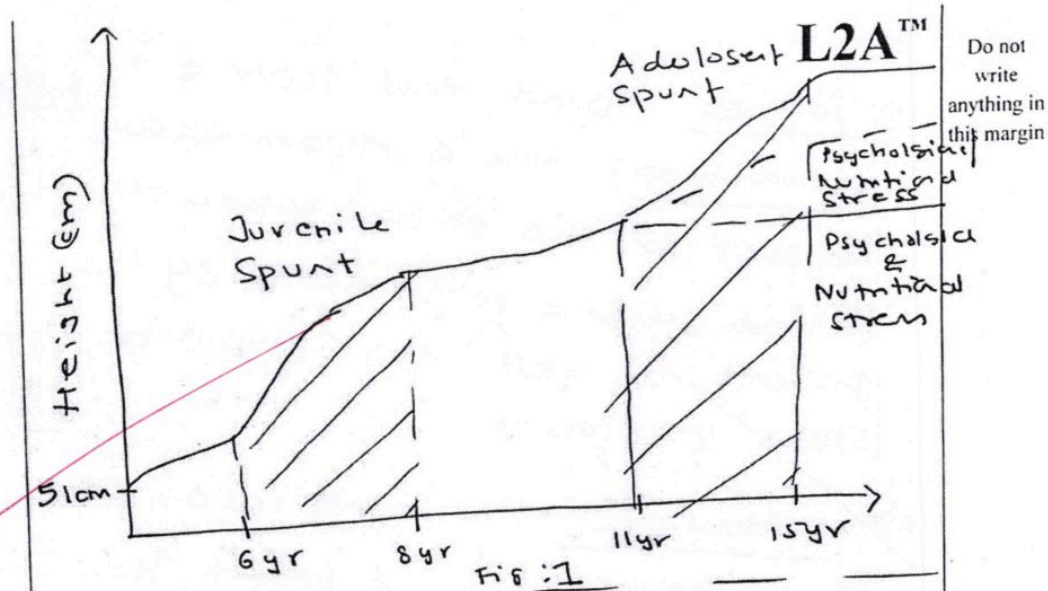
- Positive / Negative v/s Permanent Irreversible
- Occurs Later v/s Earlier
- Dependent on v/s Predictable factors
- Longer period v/s Shorter period

Similarities

- Dynamic aspects of life
- Similar stages
- Similar factors affect.

Factors affecting Growth & Development

- Genetic (1)
- Environmental (2)
- Nutritional (3)
- Hygienic (4)
- Socio-economic & Cultural (5)



Thus while spurts are genetically controlled; their expression depends on the environment which to a large degree depends on socio-economic status.

<Examples>

1) Troetich (1970): Found that Japanese living in Hawaii were 3-4cm taller than those on Mainland Japan due to better nutrition in Hawaii.

2) Studies in Kenya as well as among Saharaya tribe of Rajasthan (PVTG) have found that menarche occurs later & menopause occurs earlier thus reducing $\Rightarrow$ Reproductive span and thereby affecting the fertility (actual reproductive performance).

3) Tanner : Found that Home - **L2A™**
environment has a tremendous
impact on the child; especially the
intelligence & personality of the
parent, as well their habits of
sleep & exercise.

4) Widdowson (1948) : Found relation between
Psychological stress & Growth Hormone
release. In creche; he found that
behaviour of sister-incharge had
impact on growth of child.

5) AM Tripathi (1987) & Shukla et al (1992)
Found that Rural Sports Girls menarche
occurs on average 2-3 year later
than Urban Sports Girls.

6) If Mother smokes during pregnancy
than → Child IQ (↓) & LCM (↓). It
cannot be recovered in future.

7) Tribal IMR (38) ^{not much} ~~better~~ than National
IMR (35); but Tribal CMR (55) is much
worse than National CMR (42) as
subsequent to birth access to
health & immunisation services is
less for Tribals.

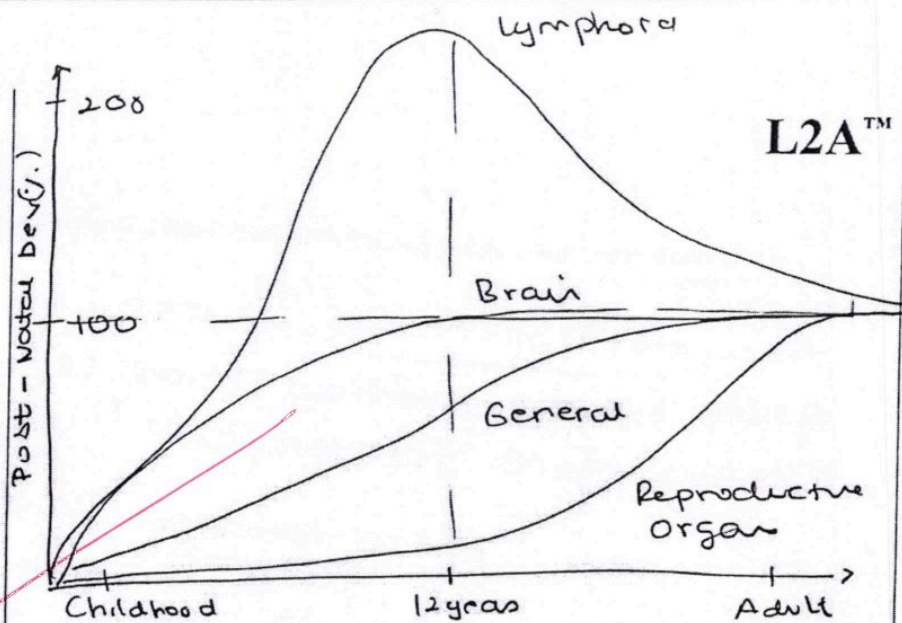
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Fig : 2 General Growth & Dev

⇒ Reproductive organ dev starts only after dev of brain is complete.

⇒ If malnutrition occurs then the maturity (adult) phase occurs earlier.

Thus the socio-economic status of the family has tremendous influence on environmental stresses that affect the Growth & Development of the individual.

Ex: If mother keeps child in A/C always then his sweat pores if not activated in childhood would never be activated.